

## Transcript 1

So for the transcription as well, I'm just going to transcribe the interview after we've recorded it. And then the moment it's on paper, I'm just going to delete it again. So that's going to be fine. So as you will know, based on the previous questionnaire, we're just going to talk a bit about homesickness and voice recordings and like the combination between those and the effects of voice recordings. And I'm just going to ask something about your personal opinions and the thoughts you have on certain topics. But just remember, you can always answer freely. So there's no wrong answers, no right answers. It's just whatever you think. So how are you feeling today?

Good. Yeah, doing good. Good weather. Good vibes.

Yeah, good weather. Yeah, that's an important one for me as well right now. Always makes it a bit better, even if it's not going that well. And just some questions to check up. So could you tell me where you're from, like originally?

So I was born in the United States. Yeah. Yeah.

And where did you grow up?

I think I mentioned it's a little difficult to describe, but for the most part of my life, I grew up in Italy.

Yes. I think, yeah, your answer was mostly Italy. Yeah. And so the country is Italy. And where do you currently live?

I live in Berlin, Germany. In Berlin.

And how did you get to Berlin, if I may ask?

So I, because I learned German in Italy, actually. Okay. And it just fell, I wanted to study in Berlin specifically, just so that I wouldn't lose the language. Yeah. And also just to utilize it. But at the same time, I ended up going into like an English course at the university. So that didn't really make sense in the end. But yeah, I wanted to move back into a big city. So Berlin's been the best place. Yeah. Yeah.

And so what do you consider to be home for you?

Home for me is definitely, at the very least, it's definitely like where I can be surrounded by, especially mountains. Yeah. But at least in nature, you know. I'm not very, I realized during my time in Berlin, I didn't really enjoy being in like very flat

surfaces or like being where there's like a lot of like grayish buildings. And home especially is also where I can spend time with like the people I cherish, whether that be friends or family. Yeah. Yeah. People who I'm connected to. Yeah.

So for you, it's not that much one location you're stuck with, one specific location, but it depends on more factors, like contextual factors.

Yeah.

Okay. And do you remember a moment where you were most homesick in your life?

Um, there have been a few moments. Um, I think especially my first few months in Berlin, I was quite homesick. Yes.

And so were you then homesick, um, to like your native country, to Italy, to, uh, to a location or more just the people?

I think it was, yeah, like, uh, I think it was mainly like people, I guess you could say location, but specifically, like I said, like mountains of like where I was in Italy and like nature itself. So I really missed that. Um, and just kind of like that kind of stillness and not just like this kind of like franticness, like that I encounter in the city more often. Um, yeah, I would say, um, I guess a bit of the environment and people is what it is to most.

Yes. So the environment and people. Um, so that's, that's interesting.

A lot of the contextual factors and location doesn't even really matter that much, I guess. Um, it's also what you're used to, of course.

Um, I'm just going to ask something to you about personality, um, within personal or either generic voice recordings. And so within my research, I'm currently studying the effect of both types of voice recordings. Um, for example, uh, listening to a piece of voice audio from a good friend of yours or like a loved one talking about, um, well, something that's close to you, um, and the effect of alleviation on homesickness or maybe vice versa. So I'm just looking for your, uh, your insights on that. And if you could think about any voice recordings, uh, you think might exist or could exist, which types of recordings can you think of that would feel more personal to you?

Do you want me to say like what I would imagine being like?

If there's, if you have any vagueness in the question, you can ask me, but you can answer it freely. So just, uh, what, how you interpret it.

Um, I mean, I'm okay. So like the way I'm interpreting it. So like what kind of voice recording would like soothe me, I guess. Yeah. So, so if you, uh, if I could maybe give a bit more information.

So with personal voice recording, I think it just needs to, uh, resonate with you a bit on a personal level. So that could be of course contextual. It could be locational, uh, the personal connection you have to someone or something, uh, as long as it resonates with you personally. And then generic is basically the opposite of that.

Mm-hmm. Okay. Okay. Um, yeah. Okay. Yeah.

You can take your time.

It's quite likely. Like, yeah, I think. I think with the generic voice recording, I suppose. Hmm. I think either way, like if I'm hearing about, let's say for example, I'm hearing about someone's day and what's going on, where they're at now. And like they're sending photos, maybe like, and they're talking about the photos. Um, I think it would probably help with the homesickness a little. Um, but whereas if they were to tell me like how much they miss like my presence or like how much, like, like how, you know, it's not the same. Like, I'm not there. Like the reminiscing back on like old times, then I would be completely different because then that would just make me more homesick.

Yeah, exactly. And then, um, as you said, the, the ones that would feel, um, that might alleviate homesickness. So for example, a friend of yours sending a photo and talking about that photo, um, do you think then the context of the photo is, uh, very, uh, well, let's say would have an influence on how personal or generic it feels to you?

Um, yeah, I think so. Yeah. I think them just sending a photo just, it might just, uh, I think in the back of my mind, it would feel like they're kind of. Showing off a little, even though that's probably not what you're doing whatsoever.

Yeah. Yeah. Exactly. Yeah. Okay. That's, that's interesting. Thank you so much. Uh, let me see. Actually in the interview as well. I have another, another questionnaire. Um, I will send you the link right now in the, in the chat of the meeting. Yeah. And then, uh, during the whole interview, you can just keep it open. Um, I've separated into three parts and then we'll just go back and forth between the interview. Okay. Um, let me see if I'm correct. That's the link. Uh, if you could check if it's working. Um, clicking on it. So it should start with just, uh, putting in the identifier again. Um, and then some questions, uh, about personal or generic voice recordings. I'll get started now. Let me see. And I'm gonna, uh, what I'm actually going to do is I'm going to let you hear, uh, five different voice recordings now, and then you can fill in the first five questions based on those recordings. So what you're, what you see right now in the, in the actual questionnaire, for example, it says someone from a, from

your native country is speaking in a native language about this and that. Um, I'm going to let you hear a voice recording that's based on the, the countries you, uh, you provided and the languages you speak that you provided, uh, would kind of resonate with that.

Okay.

Um, yes. So you can just answer it based on what you think, uh, with the person.

Okay.

Also, please let me know if you don't hear anything or if it's too, too loud. Okay. And if you want to hear it again, you can also say that.

Perfect. Okay. Sorry. It does seem quiet. I don't, I don't seem to hear the audio. It's quiet.

Okay. I'm going to try to turn it up a bit. Okay. Yeah. Yeah. That's the thing with, um, my testing for, for an interview. I can already seem to figure out how to make it a bit louder.

So would you like to go to the next one or think a bit about it? Um, I'm just thinking a bit about, uh, I'm putting like what I heard into context with like the questionnaire right now. Yeah. Um, okay. I mean, ideally should I listen to all of them first and then go through the questionnaire or as I'm hearing them, like should I like start clicking on like, okay.

Um, I think we can go, uh, one by one. So you just analyze this one and then we'll go to the next one when you've done that. Okay. It's actually a good question though. If it might be more effective to do them all. Um, the only thing I was wondering myself is if I do that, then you might have like a recency bias or just forget what you heard the first time.

Yeah. I understand that. Okay.

**[Voice recording audio: recording 1]**

Okay. Okay. Uh, next one, please.

Yes.

**[Voice recording audio: recording 2]**

And next one.

Yeah.

**[Voice recording audio: recording 3]**

[Voice recording audio: recording 10]

[Voice recording audio: recording 17]

if you can see it um i think it says um we can go and continue with the interview and then you can just keep the tab open and then come back to the questionnaire okay is that actually what it says because if not then

it says we will now continue with the interview again please leave this questionnaire open so you can continue on later on in the interview

okay great yes okay um so that was kind of the part about the personal genericness and then next up my next variable to research is meaningfulness um i'm actually gonna grab this for you um like kind of what i mean by meaningfulness because it might be a bit vague um so i mean whenever a recording kind of feels in any way important familiar or relevant to you um so if it actually means something to you and this can be emotionally for example but it could also just feel important to you without emotions um reminding you something valuable or significant um and also a voice recording could of course be very personal but not very meaningful or vice versa based on having a personal connection or not feeling important to you um so that's kind of the next part just about meaningfulness

okay

and if you think of that and with the like the vision in your head of what personalness and the meaningfulness is can you think of what makes a voice recording meaningful to you

um meaningful i would say um a meaningful voice record i mean it would be probably like um i'm trying to see like a exact difference because i suppose it doesn't necessarily have to be about me personally maybe i mean maybe i'm hearing a voice recording about um let's say they're talking about something really important happened in their life like they i don't know they maybe they pass an exam and they're like really excited and you hear this like excitement and it's so endearing to you that like it's a very meaningful moment yeah i guess for you both of course more for the person themselves but also for you because you're happy for them and you want to celebrate with them as well and like hearing that like joy maybe after a period of like a lot of stress or something you know having completed something uh you know you feel very prideful over them and that that's what makes the recording very meaningful then because like it's like a specific like a moment you know

yeah and so the example you now gave do you think uh that for example uh well of course it could feel meaningful if a good friend of yours would say something like that but if just if you see a stranger being excited in the same way you know it's about that do you think you could still feel that same meaningfulness

um definitely not in the same level um i think if it's like a stranger i think it's still endearing yeah um and perhaps memorable but because it's a stranger like yeah i probably would not be like overly excited like in my head i would probably be like oh okay good for them yeah

it's a bit more neutral instead of actually meaning something to you specifically

yeah exactly yeah

so you kind of already described it uh like the connection between your understanding of the difference between personal and genericness and a meaningfulness and if i'm right uh you basically say that of course something can be meaningful without really being personal but it's a lot easier for something to be meaningful to you when you also have a personal connection okay let me see and in which situations or with which characteristics do you think voice recordings would feel meaningful specifically to you?

uh meaningful um especially when it's celebratory or especially if it's talking about um something like relevant or like has a very impact on us i think um um i think then it would be quite a meaningful voice recording um um yeah especially if it's like relevant to me if it's like something that um could be a part of something that you know if it's something i'm also a part of i think you know that i also take a part in or have been a part of

yeah okay yeah and can you think of um maybe situations in which the same voice recording would feel more meaningful in one situation um and less meaningful in another situation? so with a situation i mean things like uh being alone or surrounded by people being uh in daytime or nighttime feeling homesick or not

yeah um especially feeling homesick i think um hearing like maybe i get a voice recording from like a family member or telling me about something that happened during their day or something like that i that's also relevant to me i think especially if i'm feeling homesick yeah it's going to be a lot more meaningful just to be able to like have like a piece of home yeah that sort of sort of way um and i think also it's different probably as well if i'm alone than if i were to be out with friends and i'm like listening to this voice recording because at that moment i'm not thinking about home i'm just thinking about the moment i'm having with friends

yeah exactly

and it's also a difference too yes so also what you're doing right now with the people you're already surrounded with um could have an impact

okay um let me see so we're just going to go back to the questionnaire now okay and it's about those same five recordings i'll let you hear them just again um you can tell me if it's if it's okay you just want to finish them and then you can rate them based on meaningfulness

okay

let me just read this one quick um okay uh all right

i'm at the first one

yeah okay, can i play it again

yeah

**[Voice recording audio: recording 1]**

**[Voice recording audio: recording 2]**

**[Voice recording audio: recording 3]**

**[Voice recording audio: recording 10]**

**[Voice recording audio: recording 17]**

all right so did you fill all five in now

yeah

yeah okay great and according to you when you listen to those five recordings do you think there's like specific elements or specific parts of the situations that you hear that affect the meaningfulness and for you which factors make it then more person more meaningful or less meaningful

so let's say uh for example especially the voice recordings i mean with the voice recording from a different in a different language uh regarding the weather like yeah there was absolutely no meaning to me i didn't even know of course like what even the weather situation was i couldn't tell really and then the fact that it's also in a different language um yeah i think like it didn't feel personal to me whatsoever um the one i run yeah interestingly um i mean it was also kind of the same situation of course also in my own native language um yes it's i understand now what you're saying but it's mainly just about the weather it's something that is only relevant for that specific day so then again it doesn't necessarily matter to me then that much yes um regarding the historical recordings um it didn't really matter to me too much when it came to the uh the one that was spoken into different language because again like it sounded kind of relevant for you know history maybe i'm not too sure but i mean i can't be sure because i don't understand what they're saying right so um i can't tell if it was really like a story and even then it was yeah and it wasn't that a big deal now



when it came to the one i believe it was from john f kennedy talking about the trying to get to the moon just starting cold war yeah i already have a lot of background knowledge behind this yeah it was taught to us at school and it was taught to us it was a historic moment for the united states of course so uh yes it's going to be a bit more meaningful um because it was just such a big moment at the time and such a big celebration now i mean like having being the first country on the moon um and then i think yeah sorry uh the one talking about the national holiday it was definitely more meaningful but specifically for the fact that because i kind of still celebrated with my own family yeah in our own kind of like like way of course celebrating thanks specifically um and also i just have very fun memories of having uh you know cooked with like people like whether it's my friends having our own kind of mini thanksgiving or when i was younger like my mom preparing some stuff with some other uh friends of hers for thanksgiving so it's in that way it's a bit more meaningful because it's talking about that kind of holiday which is which holds a lot of memories for me so yeah

exactly and kind of for you specifically um because you noted that you well you were born in the usa and you mainly grew up in italy do you think you would feel the same connections uh if it be about uh italian historical speech and for that matter like an italian holiday?

uh i think so i mean perhaps a very specific one i mean um it's very particular because i grew up in a specific region uh it's uh in south Tirol which is an autonomous region of italy okay and there is a lot of history uh back then so i think and it would definitely matter if for example i heard a speech based on like south Tirol and like you know having heard about what they're going through uh versus for example a historic speech like engine in general like about italy um i think that would be a bit different but i think as well if they were to talk about a national holiday maybe for example ferragosto i think like this is a holiday in august uh i think that would have the same impact for me like as as thanksgiving

yeah exactly okay thanks um i'm just gonna move on to the last variable which is the actual supportiveness for coping with homesickness and what i basically mean with coping with homesickness is whether you feel like the voice recording type would actually alleviate your feelings of homesickness and to what extent or maybe even worsen the feelings of homesickness and to what extent so according to your knowledge um could you please describe for me what might make a voice recording impact your experiences with homesickness um and why?

right um yeah i mean i'll definitely go over it again i mean like i mentioned before uh i think it does it does matter okay like who is talking on the voice recording um what are they talking about specifically if they're talking about something going on in their day and they wanted to share it with me that would probably alleviate some of the sickness or just like a little bit of like news you know like oh like this happened by the



way uh just thought i'd let you know um like keeping me up to date with something like that that would be uh something that would help but in the opposite on the other hand if i were to receive voice recording where i would get like feelings of missing out so let's say they're talking about someone's birthday that they celebrated without me for the first time or something um or they're talking about uh a small like day out that they went and how they were thinking about me again that would probably make me a lot more homesick a lot more wanting to like go back home to visit

yeah okay and um kind of the same as for the meaningfulness but now for the supportiveness can you think of specific situations in which the one uh on one hand the personal voice recording would be good for alleviating homesickness and on the other would kind of worsen? so the same situations can apply

of course um should i like give like an example or like

if you want yeah you can give me an example

okay um okay um sorry maybe you can repeat the question just so i know for sure

yeah no problem so can you think of a situation or multiple situations in which the same voice recording would feel more supportive for coping with homesickness in the one situation and less supportive in another situation and just to remind you the situations are for example being alone surrounded by people at home or in public um it could be different emotional situations you name it

yeah definitely yeah i think if i if i were to be in a period of my life where i'm like under a lot of stress under a lot of um a lot of expectations or like let's say i had a really bad day out in the city somewhere yeah um and then i came home feeling being in a bad mood like hearing a voice recording would probably like be a lot more helpful just kind of like to try and you know like bring back good memories in a way or like kind of bring back a good feeling um but at the same time yeah i would think i would feel more homesickness in that sense than if i were to go out having a good day come back and listen to that recording because on the one hand in the situation where i'm in a bad mood i would probably feel very i would feel nostalgic in both senses but on the one hand i would want to be back home because that's kind of like my safety net

right yeah

on the other hand if i had a good day i would feel nostalgic but i wouldn't necessarily want to feel like oh i wish i was home right now i'd be like it's nice that i have a place where you know like i could go home i'll go back home too so to speak

yeah yeah you would say you would be maybe more appreciative of the situation you have yeah but it would be like less painful in your heart to um think about the fact that the situation is not close to you right now

exactly yeah yeah

okay um let me see we can just go back to the questionnaire now for the final time and i'll just let you hear the same voice recordings again and then you can rate them on how supportive for coping with homesickness they feel to you so just on a scale of one to seven again with one not being supportive at all and seven being very supportive

okay okay

**[Voice recording audio: recording 1]**

**[Voice recording audio: recording 2]**

**[Voice recording audio: recording 3]**

**[Voice recording audio: recording 10]**

**[Voice recording audio: recording 17]**

So if everything went right, I think the questionnaire shows the end now.

Yes.

So we can go back to the very final part of the interview.

Okay.

So now just an imaginative situation. I want you to imagine someone very close to you, such as a loved one, family member, very good friend. And they are speaking to you about something personal. And how meaningful do you think such a recording would feel to you? And why?

I think it would be quite meaningful. Yeah. I mean, first point being because it's them specifically. And I guess because I relate them to the place where I mostly grew up. And like... Yeah, so like when I think of them, I also think of the area. I also think of like... My favorite places to go to. Because like when I think of a loved one, I usually... The places I go to, like where I like to go, I usually go from one side. Cherish usually as well. Yeah. So I also think of those places. And... Yeah, just it's... Yeah, it brings back those kinds of memories and makes me feel nostalgic. And makes me want to, yeah, head back and see them again. Makes me want to plan to see them again.

Yeah, exactly. And for the supportiveness. How supportive do you think such a recording would be for you and why?

Again, I guess I suppose it depends on the day, depends on the context of the recording. If the recording... If... I mean, anyway, I think it's going to be supportive anyways because it's just going to come from that. But let's say... If it's recording telling me... Like showing me their support, obviously that's going to be supportive. But if it's just them telling me about their day... In a way it's still supportive, maybe unintentionally from them. But... Again, specifically maybe because... I had like maybe a bad day and it's just nice to hear their voice. Yes. And nice to hear... Like, yeah. And if I was on a good day, like... I think... I would probably think to myself, oh, it's... Like, I'm happy that they sent me a voice recording. But, you know, not necessarily like... Letting it support my day. Kind of.

Yeah. Okay. And of course I don't know about the situation with like... Your family being in the USA or maybe in Italy or somewhere else. But do you personally think that voice recordings from people in the country you're currently living in? Or from your native country would be more supportive for homesickness coping?

Yeah, people where... Yeah. People from back home. Where I'm currently living in, it's kind of like... They're already there anyways. I could go... I could plan something immediately. Yeah. To go and hang out with them and then... So then I don't necessarily feel homesick. Or like, it doesn't necessarily like... I don't even get my homesickness. Yes, so... Right.

So you would basically... Also kind of combine this with a physical location. Like, for example, if you hear some voice recording that might... Make you a bit sad, but it's from someone that's in your neighborhood right now, you can actually do something about it. And... Yeah. Visit them.

Yeah. I would say... I would put it like this. They both... They can both... They both offer a way to cope with it. Yeah. In different ways. The person who is closer to me, like where I live now, let's say, they send a voice recording. I could offer to hang out with them as a way to distract myself from the current homesickness I'm having, you know? As a sort of like a buffer. Yeah. But if I were to get something for my family, again, depending on the situation, either... Either... I mean, yeah, either way is going to feel supportive. I'll feel like, okay, like I'm... Yes, they're thinking about me back home, you know? It's like... And I can look forward to when I get to see them again.

Yeah. In that sense. Okay. And is there anything that we have not covered yet during the interview that you would still like to share? Maybe about homesickness, about voice recordings, anything in this context?

Hmm... I think... I think we mostly covered everything. I'm not sure where I would say, where I would point anything out. I think the only thing is like, I suppose... Yeah, in my case, it's very complex because... I have a lot of people in my... Like, I have a lot of people who I cherish, but they're very, like, widely spread out across a lot of places. Yep. Um... So I think that's what makes it difficult to define, like, where home is, but I can still feel homesick, you know? I can still miss a person's presence, or I can miss a certain environment that, for a period of time, was coming to me. Or, like, yeah. Yeah. That's pretty much it.

Okay. And if you're willing to share this, and also if you can come up with it, if you could choose, like, one kind of voice recording, maybe you have one in mind, or what could be a voice recording, that would feel most meaningful, most helpful in alleviating your homesickness. So what would this be?

I could choose. Would, like, something like a video count?

I think as long as there's audio, you could specify that the video adds more value.

Okay. That's true. I mean, I guess audio-wise... It's hard to say, because I don't normally get with audio, because I usually just get a phone call, but... I mean, maybe phone calls count, I don't know.

Of course, yeah.

Um... Suppose... Like... Yeah, like a phone call from my mom, you know, or, like, sometimes she leaves a... It's very rare, but she leaves a voice audio sometimes. Um... Talking about her day. And it's usually... It's very routine, whatever she's talking about. But then I think there's some familiarity in that. Because, you know, I was a part of that routine one time. Like, so I know already, like, what she usually does. Yeah. And so, like, hearing her talk about it, it's like... Like, ah, yes, I'm... Same old, you know. But it's nice. And that's, like... Like, even when I'm not there, it's still happening.

Exactly. Yeah. I can imagine. Um... Let me see. Yeah, just... Finally, is there anything else you would like to add?

Uh... No. I mean, other than... I think this is a pretty interesting study. I'd like to know, like, what the findings are, I think, of this study regarding homesickness.

Yes. I can... I can write it down. And then I can possibly just send you the final thesis as well. But also just maybe a results section. I will be doing some prototype testing. But I will be basing some updates that I still have to do to the prototype on answers that I get from the interview. So, when I get to that point, I'm just going to send out

some more emails asking if people want to try to participate in that. And then I'll see you from there.

Okay. Great.

All right.

Yeah.

Thank you so much.

Thank you.